

Three improvements to your summary

Many papers found good facts and told events clearly. Now explain how those facts fit together.

Think of editing a documentary: accurate scenes can mislead if you remove the connections or ending.

1. Place in the book

Where does this scene fit?

Explain what the chapter adds to the book's larger account.

Chapter 3: After earlier invasions, Egan examines a human response: introducing salmon to control alewives and create a sport fishery.

2. Explain the causes

Why does one event lead to another?

Connect events with **because** or **enabled** when Egan supports the connection.

Chapter 5: Chicago's canal connected separate watersheds, creating a possible route for carp toward the Great Lakes.

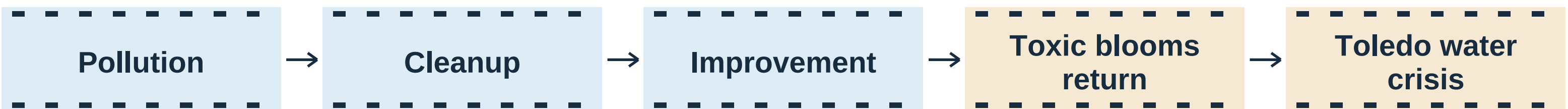
3. State the thesis

What does the whole account establish?

Name Egan's main claim, including any crucial condition or limit.

Chapter 7: Earlier pollution controls improved Lake Erie, but that recovery did not provide lasting protection.

Chapter 7: stopping at improvement changes the argument



Before drafting: write one sentence each for place, causes, and thesis. Then choose supporting details.

For synthesis: understand each source's argument before comparing arguments and making your own claim.